the Nazi era. The Syrian-born Sheikh 'Izz a-Din al-Qassam (in whose honor Hamas named its rockets and its "military" wing) and the undisputed Palestinian nationalist leader and Grand Mufti of Jerusalem, Haj Amin el-Husseini—both of whom waged war in the 1930s against the British and the Jews in Palestine—were among the leading advocates of jihad in those years. During World War II, Haj Amin did everything in his power to ensure that not a single Jew should escape from the inferno of Nazi-occupied Europe and he was a major instigator of the devastating pogrom in Baghdad in June 1941.[4]

Since the heyday of the Grand Mufti, anti-Judaism and anti-Zionism have come to form an inextricable unity in the Arab world. Attitudes toward Jews are seen as part of a broader religious struggle between Islamic and Western civilization—a battle between God and Satan—defined as an existential war and not simply as a question of borders. In Islamist terms, the territorial and military assault against the Jewish State in order to regain *all* of Palestine is part of the war for Allah and the honor of the entire Muslim *umma* (nation).

The cleansing of the Christian presence from the Muslim Middle East is revealing in this regard. The Islamic State of Syria and the Levant (ISIL or ISIS), currently controlling large swathes of northern Syria and Iraq, obliged the ancient Christian Chaldean community of Mosul either to convert to Islam, abandon their property, or face immediate execution by beheading. Indeed, Middle Eastern Christians are being ethnically cleansed by Islamists across the region. Yet Hamas—which is part of the same jihadi family—continues to benefit in many quarters in the West from a highly romanticized view of the Palestinian "Other." Politically, Hamas even raised its profile during the Gaza war to the point of being considered by many as an equal partner for "negotiation" with Israel.

Among Hamas's most prominent and passionate supporters has been the new Turkish president (and long-time Prime Minister), Recip Tayyip Erdoğan, reputedly U.S. President Obama's best friend in the Middle East. In recent years he has displayed an extraordinarily violent Jew-hatred, repeatedly labelling Israel a "terror state" that inflicts "systematic genocide" against Palestinians. Erdoğan has indeed deliberately cultivated anti-Israel and anti-Jewish feelings in Turkish society.[5] He did not hesitate in 2013 to proclaim that the growing domestic opposition to his government was the result of a "Jewish conspiracy"; or that the Turkish mining disaster which occurred in May 2014 had a "Jewish" angle. Erdoğan's hostility evidently finds an echo in the Turkish population in which almost 80% apparently harbor anti-Jewish prejudices.

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,